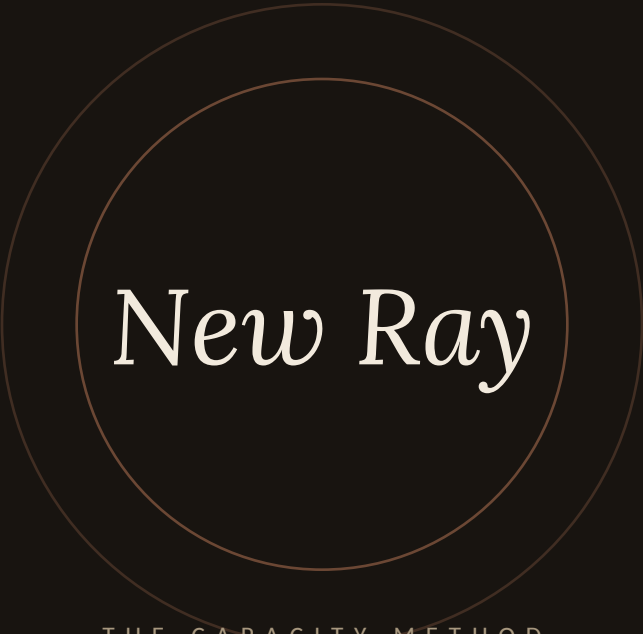




New Ray

THE CAPACITY METHOD

PART ONE

The Capacity Assessment

Stop expecting 100% from yourself on 20% days.

Created by Vanessa Parkin, RN

Welcome

If you're reading this, there's a good chance you're tired. Not just physically tired — the kind of tired that comes from carrying too many responsibilities, making too many decisions, and trying to hold everything together while still being expected to perform at your best.

For years, I thought the answer was better time management. A better planner. More discipline. More motivation. But the truth was simpler: I kept expecting the same output from myself regardless of what I was carrying.

As a Registered Nurse, wife, and mother of two young children, I had seasons where I felt constantly behind. Some days I felt capable and focused. Most days I felt depleted before the day even started — yet I was still measuring myself against my good days. I was expecting Green Day performance on Red Day energy.

“This isn’t about lowering your standards. It’s about working with reality instead of against it.”

What is capacity?

Capacity is the amount of physical, mental, and emotional energy available to you today.

Your capacity changes constantly — even as the day goes on. Factors that affect it include sleep quality, stress, illness, work demands, parenting, hormonal fluctuations, postpartum recovery, relationship challenges, and the invisible mental load. Most of us recognize these factors. Very few of us adjust our expectations accordingly.

The capacity trap

Imagine your phone battery is at 10%. You wouldn't expect it to function like it's fully charged. You'd close unnecessary apps, turn on battery-saving mode, and charge it when you could.

Yet many of us wake up at 10% and still expect ourselves to work at full capacity, care for everyone, exercise, clean, answer every message, and stay positive. When we inevitably struggle, we assume something is wrong with us.

The problem is often not you. The problem is the expectation.

The color system

Red Day	0–35% · Battery critically low. Not the day to push harder — the day to protect your energy.
Yellow Day	36–70% · Enough energy to function, but not unlimited. Today's goal is balance.
Green Day	71–100% · Energized and capable. Best for planning, growth, and bigger projects.

Don't worry about choosing the perfect percentage. The goal is awareness, not precision. The mistake many people make is assuming every day should be a Green Day — or that we must do everything as if we were at Green Day capacity. That expectation is unrealistic and exhausting.

The capacity assessment

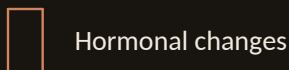
Take a moment to check in honestly. Not who you wish you were today. Not who you were a year ago. Not who social media tells you to be. **Who are you today?**

Today I am operating at:

0% 10% 20% 30% 40% 50% 60% 70% 80% 90% 100%

What's affecting my capacity?

☐	Poor or interrupted sleep
☐	Pregnancy / postpartum / breastfeeding
☐	Physical illness
☐	Chronic stress
☐	Work demands
☐	Financial stress
☐	Relationship stress
☐	Parenting challenges
☐	Anxiety or mental exhaustion
☐	Grief or loss



Hormonal changes

The most important question

“If you truly accepted your capacity today — what would you stop feeling guilty about?”

Capacity & your cycle

One of the most common reasons a woman’s capacity fluctuates is hormonal change across the menstrual cycle. Our bodies are not designed to operate at identical capacity 365 days a year — yet many of us judge ourselves as though they should.

Follicular	After your period — often more motivation, focus, and energy. A natural time for goal-setting and new habits.
Ovulation	High energy, confidence, and communication. A natural time for growth and connection.
Luteal	Lower patience, more fatigue and sensitivity. Simplify schedules and protect recovery time.
Menstrual	Fatigue and a greater need for rest for some; others feel normal. The goal is awareness, not a category.

FROM VANESSA

One of the biggest changes I ever made was realizing that capacity is not character.

Low capacity does not mean you’re lazy. It does not mean you’re failing. It means you’re human.

The goal isn’t perfect days. It’s responding appropriately to the day you’re actually having.

Now that you’ve identified your capacity, the next step is learning how to respond to it. In the Red Day Protocol, you’ll learn how to adjust expectations, protect your energy, and define success on low-capacity days without guilt.